Petrichor

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/32566123.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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Gen

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Gods & Goddesses, Goddesses, Adora is the earth, Catra is the rain, they love each other very, Reunions, Love, Alternate Universe - Soulmates, Soulmates, Angst with a Happy Ending, kind of angst, Humans being humans, take care of the earth please, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, Established Relationship, goddess adora, Goddess Catra

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Petrichor

by StarryNap

Summary

This is the way they love each other.

Adora loves her with the force of life. Is liquid gold that travels in the layers and cracks of the ground and brings it to plentiful life.

Catra loves Adora like a typhoon. Devastating. Beautiful. Dangerous. Exhilarating. The earth and the rain are so intertwined together that you can't have one without the other.

Notes

I went to take a walk under the rain and got inspired to write a little poetic thing about the earth and the rain loving each other. At some point it took life on its own and took a deeper path.

Enjoy ')

See the end of the work for more notes

PETRICHOR

When the last tree has been cut down

The last fish caught

The last river poisoned

Only then will we realize

We cannot eat money

-**Cree Indian Proverb**

Music that inspired this story x x x

✾

Adora's bare feet step in the dry grass. Her hair is loose, long and golden against the dim light of the dead forest. It floats softly with the breeze across the sharp angles of her face, framing her like moss to the stone, like clouds to the sun. Her robes, that are not white but also any other color, tangle around her legs when she walks over the darkened dirt that one was an evergreen grass. She slides over it, her gentle soles not quite touching the ashes scattered over the ground.

In the solitude, her skin looks pale and tired, almost translucent, with small swirls of magic dancing under it, enveloping her in a gentle golden glow. Still, she doesn't look like herself, a light down version of who she truly is, too sad and too pained. Looking around the devastated place, Adora feels small and powerless, filled with the nostalgic sense of mournful acceptance. She is not angry. She just is.

Adora looks up to the grey expanse of the sky, her blue blue *blue* eyes mirroring the incoming tempest with barely contained crave just like blooms that seek the sun at dawn. There are huge clouds

that spin quickly one over the other, crashing in themselves in a savage dance that falls over the dead forest with the force of an entire ocean. The air feels heavy, almost electrified, and the earth itself seems to vibrate with it, opening her arms to accept its gentle fall once it comes.

Adora waits. For a few seconds or a couple of millenniums, she doesn’t know. She doesn't care. She would wait forever, until she herself becomes to ashes if that means to have her back in her arms.

It's a dangerous thought, loving so much. It's almost human. But how couldn't she. After all, they are a part of each other, they can't exist without the other's breathing. It's almost logical, destined, loving her. So she waits and when the sky roars open and the rain finally comes, Adora smiles, the drizzle falling over her robes and hair and ethereal face in quiet gentleness, soft droplets that kiss her entire skin like a lover's touch. In a way, it is.

It’s not cold, not to her. It would never hurt her, never raise against her. It’s warm as the hand of her lover caressing her skin. It drenches her completely, filling her lungs with air, lifting the weight on her chest, growing life inside of her again.

The branches behind her crack under a second weight. Adora still doesn’t turn, taking in the increasing rain as her smile widens. She knows that she is doing it on purpose, the noise, as to not startle her. As if Adora didn’t recognize the slightest fluttering of her presence over her own earth, like butterfly wings against her cheeks. As if Adora didn’t know by memory her smell, pleasant and fresh after a long time of dryness. *Petrichor*, she called it once. *Home*, answered Adora back.

The seeker finally reaches her. She feels a pair of arms wrapped around her chest, tight, so tight it robs her from her newfound breath. She basks in her smell, in the feeling of her physical body against hers.

Just as the iridescent drops that fall from the sky, she is warm.

“Adora” comes her voice. It seems to come from everywhere around them and at the same time is private, intimate, just for Adora’s ears. In the distance, a single thunder strikes the sky in blues and purples. She places light kisses above her bare shoulders, painting opal constellations with each stroke of her honey soft lips. And every touch is a declaration and a promise. An *I love you* and an *I’m here,* over and over again like angelic choruses until all Adora can feel, breath and taste is her in every part of her skin.

“My love” Adora answers, the steam of her breath raising mist among the breeze as the rain increases its force, covering the earth in a wide and loving embrace. Her love tightens her arms around her, the waterfalls of her storm rumbling like a feline’s purr.

It takes them a while, holding each other in the top of the cliff, until Adora’s want gets the better of her and she turns slowly in the circle of her arms looking at her face clear and open for the first time since the red bird had devoured her woods. She is bare, as she always is when she is around Adora. The curves of her body flow like water, rising in small perked mountains, falling in dips of smooth mud, deepening in a hot damp carven. Lean legs like newborn icebergs, the arcs of her feet bending as moon lakes where Adora likes to rest her ethereal mouth for eternities. Her face is lovely, barely containing the force that is so unequivocally her. And her dark hair falls like rivers behind her, untamed, free.

She is wild. She is terrifying. She is beautiful.

She is Adora’s. And Adora is hers.

Adora doesn’t remember ever existing a day without her. She doesn’t know who was created first, she can’t really remember it. Maybe they were two forces living separately that somehow ended up gravitating together, colliding against the other. Maybe they were created together, joined. One being that was separated

in two so they could find each other again and again. Maybe she woke up when Adora extended her sleepy arms towards the new earth, cooing her into covering the world with her drowsy, mercyful tears. Maybe Adora woke up by her gentle kisses falling one by one on her earth, filling her with joy and hope.

Is a mystery, even for them. But what Adora does know is that when she opened her eyes, she was already there and that Adora had loved her intensely from that moment on. And that she loved her back. And from that love, life grew anew.

So here they are now, thousands of hundreds years after. Adora cradles her face between her palms and it is not the first time that she thanks being able to catch the rain with her hands. Her love looks at her, with the sun and the moon nestled in her eyes overflowing with the waves of her emotions and pouring down their feet in small puddles. She tears her gaze from Adora's just so she can look at their surroundings. Adora contemplates her as she takes in the destruction, the cracked trees, the black grass, the dormant bird that breathes black puffs of ashes into the sky. Gone is the green and the yellow and the blues and in its place is only deafening silence broken only by the spell of her storm.

Something shifts in her eyes, Adora sees, something as red as the burning monster. Is love, pain, worry, but above all anger. Rage. The sky turns itself apart with lightning and just for a second Adora worries they will strike the earth again and awaken it all again. Except that of course it doesn't. Decay is natural, it gives things purpose, missions, desires. Is as normal as when lighting crisps the flowers stems into nothing or when the sometimes merciless sun creates its own destructive red birds. But this, this is abnormal. This is a careless mistake, a high price to pay for a second of ignorance.

She snaps back to Adora, holding onto the back of her strong hands with hail cutting nails, slightly prickling the ethereal flesh there. Over them, the storm has turned ink black and the water starts dragging away the remains of the pain on its walk, washing it all clean and fresh.

“Who did this?” she asks Adora, panting at the same rhythm as her lightings.

“You know who, beloved” she whispers back, small, so small. She is barely a strand on her usual self, her golden light dim against the sad remains of life. Her lover sees this, with eyes swimming in raged tears and her pupils only pinpoints of darkness against the usual joyful colors. When they are in this form she likes to paint her eyes in yellow and blue, reflecting Adora's flowers in brushes of love. Now the storm that lashes against the world swirls in her eyes in purples and reds and Adora wishes none of this had happened as long as she could keep her away from the mourn.

“You love them too much” comes in her voice, strained with contained emotions and oh, how much Adora adores her, it tears her heart apart and open.

“Maybe” Adora says, daring to take her eyes away from the storm of her face and around, regarding with a resigned sigh the lonely remains. “They are ignorant and self destructive but there is beauty and compassion in them too- Maybe you would love them too if you knew them better”

“I do not love them” bites her lover, sharp teeth tearing the sky apart, crashing over the ocean with violence. Yet she holds Adora with such delicacy, cradling her in her arms with only soft touches and the loveliest kisses, as if they weren't two universal forces capable of bending the world or breaking it into pieces. And when she speaks again her voice is more tamed, just a breeze of air against Adora's cheekbones. “I only love you"

This is the way they love each other.

Adora loves her with the force of life. With death and rebirth and joy and grief. Is liquid gold that travels in the layers and cracks of the ground and brings it to plentiful life. Is creatures of the sun and creatures of the night, circling each other in their ephimer times just to come back to the earth embrace and start again. Adora loves her like flowers love sunrise, like the ground drinks

water, like the smallest creatures that consume rotten tissue. It is so much, it is overwhelming. Adora wakes up every time for her and just for her and when she is gone Adora's earth dies in grief, missing her every second until she comes back. And if they didn't have each other, if they didn't love each other, the world would consume itself until all would be gone and forgotten. That's the way Adora loves her.

And she. She loves Adora like a typhoon. Devastating. Beautiful. Dangerous. Exhilarating. Her love could break stone and wood and the strongest of metals. It's a love that devours everything on it's path, merciless, violent, exciting. There is no comparison, no possible competitor. Nobody can control the rain, nothing can stop the water. The earth and the rain are so intertwined together that you can't have one without the other. And every time Adora is hurt and tired, she will open the skies in rage to cover her in healing drops of her own magic, tucking Adora in the safe feeling that is her, always by her side. And sometimes in her reckless intense love creatures will fear her, fear them both, together, as the cold harsh water washes everything away. And Adora will look at them in pity because they don't understand that in her rage her lover tries to heal her, to bring her back out of the damage they have submerged her into.

"Do you love them more than me?" She asked once, one time when the ignorant creatures had poisoned the air and with it her rain, making it burn and scratch Adora's skin. And she had cried in endlessly grief inside Adora's arms until the venom washed away completely and they were sore and exhausted.

Later they had laid together, entangled flesh and bone, tongue and skin, hidden away from prying selfish eyes for months in the highest point in the world. They had wrapped themselves in a blanket of obliviousness, letting the grotesque truth fall outside for just a moment, licking each other’s mouths and wounds and wombs until they felt not new but better. Happier. The soft chorus of sighs that left Adora's mouth had made pine trees shake and volcanos hum, and when her lover shook in gentle release a cold rain fell over them and winter arrived.

"They are my creatures too". Answered Adora, after, cradling her close to her warm beating chest.

"That's not what I asked" She wriggled uncomfortably against Adora and so did the drizzle outside, freezing until it wasn't water anymore but soft puffs of snow. Adora felt them saunter sadly over her and she tightened her hold on her waist, ghosting her peach lips over her damp forehead again and again.

"I do not love them more than you. But I do not love you more than them". Her love didn't answer for a long time, for several moon cycles, until it was almost spring again and Adora had to prepare to leave. When she did, however, she nestled her face on Adora's moss neck and placed lazy mist kisses there, whispering.

"Explain it to me". Adora drew lazy swirls over her back and the creases and dips of her spine, caresses that became flows in the oceans and wild flowers blooming in mountains.

"They are my creatures" Adora explained "Just like all the others. They are born out of me, they feed off me, live off me, love off me and eventually die off me. Their lives are so short and they are so ignorant, so vulnerable, so afraid"

"But they hurt you" insists the rain, conflicted frown between her eyebrows that crackle with static. "They burn you, break you, poison you, change you. It hurts you. I see it. I see the black patches in your body, the raggedness of your breath. They think they own you. And they *hurt* you, hurt us, and everything that surrounds them too"

"They do," admitted Adora, smiling nonetheless. "And yet I love them"

"Why?", questions her love, voice high pitched voice in honey sweet confusion. As if her rain didn't bring health and hope and shelter to all living creatures too, as if she wasn't made of liquid hope. As if she wasn't the reason the colors exist and grow and live, live, live, cleaning the air from heavy smokes, soothing the

red and blue flames into nothing, filling the lakes and rivers and waterfalls and oceans. As if her beloved's hands didn't take with the kindest care the destroyed gone pieces of life and guide them back into Adora's patient embrace.

"Because I still have faith in them. Because their goodness still overcomes their darkness. There are patches of green and pink and blue too. They still take care for my other creatures. Sometimes is too much, but they are mine and I live for all of them"

Adora watched the snow cover the world in bright white and the soothing cold made her breath in relief, nuzzling closer to her beloved with each intake of air.

"It 's different. With you" Adora continued, lips pressed with lips "You are a part of me, too. Just not like them. You are my core and my essence. You are mingled with the lava of my bones, with the branches of my blood, with the breeze of my breath. I do not live without you. Nothing on this earth could live without you. You are essential, you are important, you are everything. You are my only wish, my one desire, my perfect selfishness. I'm completely devoted to you and there is nothing that compares to you. I wouldn't want or wish to exist if you were gone. Me and them, we only live because you live. That's the way I love you."

Adora loses herself in the memory as the rain pours all around them, soaking them to the very inside, and she feels herself slowly getting better. The golden glow on her face shines just a little bit brighter, the rose of her cheeks returns like cherry blossoms in springs. When Adora looks at her Rain again. The tempestuous expression is still there but is mixed, joined by another one. One that speaks of centuries and millenniums of love. Adora sees the longing, the worry, the hope, the black of her eyes that has started to slip away like ink in water.

The clouds open just a fraction and allow a lonely sunshine to cross them, brightening the dark earth in gold new light. Under this light Adora sees the rainbow reflected on her love's tears and

she bends to kiss them away, her own eyes matching the flow in earthquake heartbreak.

"Nothing bad is going to happen" Adora whispers to the rain and she can feel herself quivering and coming back together, can feel herself repair under the soft touch of her hands. "We have each other"

I love you, she says without need for words and the other understands.

The rain is still strong and relentless, a force of nature unable to be tamed or stopped. The earth is powerful and giving, breaking anew with rebirth by her embrace. And when their lips mingle one more time out of millions, the world sighs in solace. And under their celestial feet, green stems are born from the ashes.

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A kiss, when all is told, what is it? An oath taken a little closer, a promise more exact.

A wish that longs to be confirmed, a rosy circle drawn around the verb 'to love'.

A kiss is a secret which takes the lips for the ear, a moment of infinity humming like a bee, a communion tasting of flowers,

a way of breathing in a little of the heart and tasting a little of the soul with the edge of the lips

— **Edmond Rostand,** *Cyrano de Bergerac*

End Notes

Take care of the Earth

The Rain loves her

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